

Dear [Name],

As a retired South San Antonio ISD teacher, I remain deeply interested in the district and increasingly concerned about issues affecting teachers, students, and campuses. I have been trying to locate evidence showing that teacher effectiveness was a primary cause of low academic performance, or explaining why districtwide NIET/TAP was determined to be the appropriate response.

The most recent publicly available Comprehensive Needs Assessment I have been able to review, from March 2024, identified teacher turnover as the only staff-quality concern; it did not identify ineffective teaching or inadequate teacher capacity as a root cause of low academic performance. Yet within two months of taking office, the superintendent moved to implement NIET/TAP districtwide, significantly restructuring and increasing teachers' work and limiting their professional discretion through tightly prescribed curriculum and instructional requirements. At the April 14, 2025, Board meeting where NIET/TAP was approved, TEA Conservator Abe Saavedra also stated that a new district Needs Assessment would be conducted over the following several weeks. The new district Needs Assessment therefore does not appear to have been completed before the Board voted to approve NIET/TAP that night.

Because TEA states that the Board of Managers assumes the powers and responsibilities of the elected Board of Trustees and oversees the management of the district, I am asking what independent review you personally conducted before approving NIET/TAP. What evidence did you review, and how did you evaluate it beyond the administration's recommendations or presentations? Please answer based on your own review and decision-making:

- **Before voting in April 2025, what specific evidence did you personally review?** Did it show that teacher effectiveness, instructional quality, or teacher capacity was a primary cause of low academic performance? If so, what did it show, and how can the public review that analysis?
- **Did you or the Board of Managers seek teacher input or examine potential drawbacks before approving NIET/TAP?** What information was considered regarding workload, turnover, implementation demands, costs, and whether a phased or targeted approach would have been more appropriate?
- **Did you review the later district Needs Assessment, and what did it find?** A conservator progress report states that the assessment was completed in draft form and would be finalized after review and feedback from the superintendent and Board president. What findings did it contain regarding teacher effectiveness or teacher capacity, and where can the public review it?
- **What root-cause and data analysis was presented to the Board in August 2025?** The Implementation Plan for the August 25 workshop lists "Administration Data Analysis & Root Cause Recommendations" as an August activity assigned to the superintendent. The workshop video and transcript indicate that materials were shown during that analysis, yet the district later stated in response to a public information request that there was no presentation to provide. What materials were shown, did you receive or retain them, and can they be made available for public review?

- **What other possible causes of low academic performance did the Board of Managers examine before approving NIET/TAP, such as attendance, mobility, staffing, discipline, socioeconomic factors, learning loss, curriculum, and student-support systems?** What strategies have been enacted to address those factors? Please identify any analysis, reports, data, or other materials the Board relied upon in considering them.

Given that significant concerns have emerged since NIET/TAP implementation began, I believe the public should understand what evidence the Board of Managers relied upon, what alternatives were considered, and how the decision is being monitored.

I intend to make these questions, along with any responses or lack thereof, publicly available so that the South San community can better understand how this decision was evaluated, implemented, and monitored by the Board of Managers.